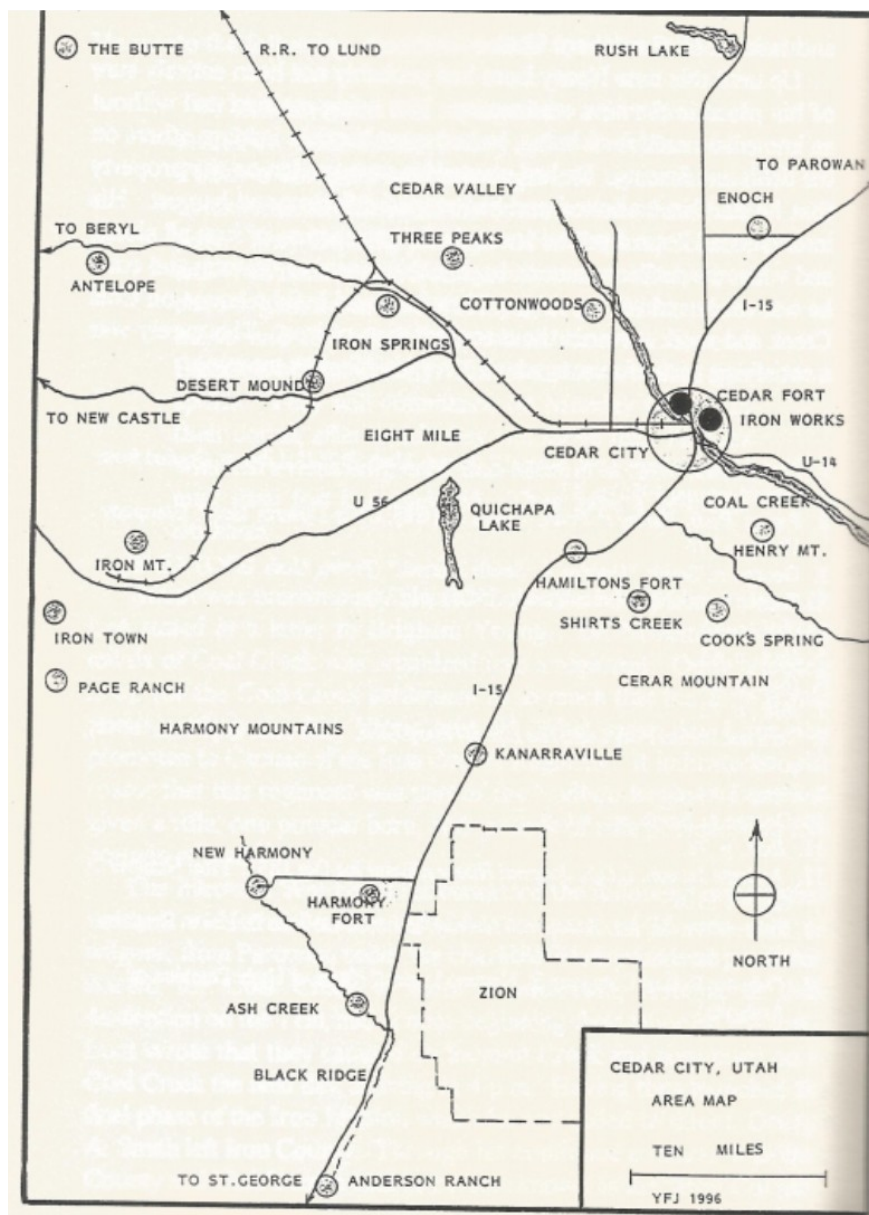


CHAPTER V CEDAR CITY 1852

Henry Lunt was the first of the thirty-six men called on November 5, 1851, to settle Coal Creek which was approximately twenty miles south of Parowan. These men constituted that group:¹

James Baird	Peter M. Fife	Thomas Rowland
William Bateman	Richard Harrison	William Slack
James Bulloch	Robert Henry	John Stoddard
Thomas Cartwright	Nephi Johnson	William Stone
George Cassell	S. Johnson	James Thorpe
John Chatterley	Alexander Kier	John Tout
Joseph Chatterley	Henry Lunt	Samuel West
Alexander Easton	James H. Martineau	James Whittaker Jr.
George Easton	William C. Mitchell	James Whittaker Sr.
John Easton	Alexander Ross	Edward Williams
Robert Easton	Daniel Ross	James Williamson
William Evans	Duncan Ross	William Woods ²

After the area was surveyed by William H. Dame, George A. Smith dedicated the ground and gave it the name of Cedar City due to the abundance of cedar trees. Smith made the following statement:

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In humility before God, together with the rest of my fellow pioneers, I dedicate the ground just surveyed, the surrounding land, the minerals, the water, the timber and grass to the service of God in the manufacture of iron, machinery etc., that our necessities might be met and the territory built up.³

Most of the men left their families in Parowan when they left for Coal Creek. After the new settlers arrived at their destination November 11, 1851, the first task was to "fort up" as a defense against the Indians and build a corral for the livestock. At first the new company of men camped by what is called "the knoll" (north of present Cedar City). Henry lived with James Whittaker in a wagon box with James' 18-year-old son. This was temporary, only until the rest of the Whittaker family arrived. It was no small feat that had transpired in just a year's time. Here they were, establishing the second settlement in the midst of semi-hostile savages, and they felt their prayers for the preservation of their lives and property had been answered. Building facilities to corral the livestock took first precedence. They all worked on the corrals during the day and met around the campfire in the evening. Such heavy work was difficult in the cold November air.

James Whittaker and his family who Henry was staying with had sailed from Liverpool, England on the ship, *George W. Bourne*, January 23, 1851, arriving in New Orleans March 20. They traveled up the Mississippi to St. Louis, then journeyed up the Missouri River to Kaneshville, Iowa, arriving the 27th of May. The entire family came with one of the pioneer companies to Salt Lake, reaching their destination September 27, 1851. James and his family came on to Parowan with the Iron Mission that fall where Henry became well acquainted with the family.⁴

The crops had been harvested in Parowan before the company left. Although the food was of a coarse character which contributed to digestive problems, they had plenty to eat. However, there was also some uncertainty about replenishment of clothing and shoes.⁵ A great deal of patching was being done on what little clothing they had.

Henry's oldest daughter, Henrietta, later wrote: that "Henry's clothes were commencing to wear out, his shoes had already gone, so he went to meeting in his broadcloth clothes, silk hat, and barefooted. One time he got a boot top and made soles for his feet, as they were sore from walking on the rough brushy ground."⁶

A Scotch immigration company consisting of sixteen wagons arrived on Tuesday, November 18. James and Isabella Bulloch and their family, who had left Scotland February 20, 1848, were among the settlers who were called by President Brigham Young to go to Coal Creek. James had spent some time in St. Louis where he and Matthew Carruthers purchased a farm together in order to earn enough money for supplies to travel on to Utah. Bulloch's son, David D. (seven years old) arrived in Cedar City ahead of the others, riding from Summit with a man hauling supplies. He was greeted by Henry Lunt who patted him on the head and said, "My boy, you have the honor of being the first white boy on this creek." The new arrivals placed their wagons in line, each facing south, and made a brush wickiup to shield the campfires from the winter winds. At this time the men who were already there were building a stockade corral out of driftwood they had found along the creek banks. They were living in their wagon boxes which had been removed from the running gears. Dave Bulloch wrote the following about the Indians:

We always tried to treat them kindly, and whenever they stole from us, as they often did, or committed any other offense against us, we reported it to the Indian Chief. We knew it would be best to let him punish them, for whatever punishment he gave them they were forced to take, but they never seemed to forgive a white man for bringing them to justice. The punishment most frequently given them was the whipping post. I remember seeing the Indians tied to our Liberty Pole, and seeing them whipped so hard that the blood oozed out of their skins. Later there was a guardhouse on each side of the Cedar Fort which was manned at all times in fear of the Indians.⁷

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After supper, when the men gathered around the campfire, Brother Lunt exhorted the brethren to "obey counsel and suffer wrong rather than do wrong, and, for the sake of a few house logs, not to let the devil get into their midst."⁸ Apparently, it was decided that everyone would cut and haul logs for the corral before they gathered materials for their own use. Finally, after morning prayer, a few men went up the canyon to get the last pickets to finish the corral on Tuesday, November 20. The rest of the men started on the water ditch. Brothers Lunt and Chatterley determined the place where the water should be taken from the creek.

The Utah settlers felt that it was a treat when they received the *Deseret News* which was a newspaper published in Salt Lake City. The Bishops helped with the distribution of the paper. The following statement appeared in the *News* November 15, 1851:

The *Deseret News* is published every other Saturday; terms: 3 months--\$1.25, in advance. Agents: John Stoker--North Canyon; A. L. Lamoreaux--North Cottonwood; Isaac Higbee--Utah; Nelson Higgins--Sanpete; Ezra T. Benson--Tooele; and Henry Lunt--Iron County. We shall send the subscribers papers to our agent nearest their residence. Butter, cheese, eggs, fowls, ducks, geese, quail, snipes, prairie chickens, beans, molasses, pork, mutton, wood poles, corn, oats, shingles, lumber, cash, and everything good will be accepted in payment of the *News*.

Matthew Carruthers was assigned the position of Presiding Elder on November 21, 1851. This calling gave him the responsibility of being the civic and ecclesiastical leader of Cedar City. The settlers met that afternoon and were addressed by Carruthers, Lunt, and Brother Gould. After the meeting Brother Lunt rebaptized seven brethren and sisters in Coal Creek--Joseph Chatterley, James Williamson, Dan Ross, Dan Ross Jr., Mary Caston, Alex and Marion Keis. They were confirmed in the evening by Lunt and Carruthers.⁹

The men of Cedar City spent Tuesday, November 25, making a wind break around each of the wagons out of cedar trees. James Whittaker, who had been visiting his family in Parowan, arrived back in the settlement that day with his daughter, Ellen. Many families were moving now that the corral was completed. During a meeting the following evening, Lunt announced that everyone could work at cutting their own house logs the next day.

Bishop Johnson, of Parowan, visited the settlement on Sunday, November 30, and attended the noon meeting. Some of the brethren expressed their discontent with two of the brethren who had cut a set of house logs before the public works was finished. One of these men was President Carruthers.¹⁰ However, during the month of December all the settlers worked on their own homes, only donating one day a week to public works. In spite of their anxiousness to complete their homes, they faithfully held meeting each week on Sunday. When food became short, it was necessary to make a trip to Parowan to replenish supplies.

Whittaker wrote the following on Sunday, December 21 concerning his family in Parowan:

Dull morning. Commenced snowing about 9 o'clock a.m. continuing until noon. I went to Parowan with three yoke of cattle for mother, sisters, and wagon. Arrived at 5 ½. That same day at about 12 o'clock [noon] John C. L. Smith, John L. Smith, James Lewis, Tarlton Lewis, James A. Little, W. H. Dame, and John Steele arrived at Coal Creek from Parowan. They had a meeting at about 3 o'clock when these visitors addressed the congregation and said they were well pleased with the progress made. The meeting closed at 5 ½ p.m., and they met again at 6 ½ and continued till 12 o'clock night.

Henry Lunt visited all the people and told them to prepare for a public dinner at noon on December 22. James Whittaker wrote: "They did so, and the table was filled with a good dinner such as

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would not disgrace the most refined part of the world." The Parowan brethren enjoyed themselves very much. Several toasts and three cheers were given to President Brigham Young. There wasn't too much celebrating done on Christmas Day for, according to the same entry, "it was a very cold day with snow and sleet, and they worked on the house."

While herding cattle, Brother Robert Owen's son, Jerome, shot Brother Pugmire's son on January 2, 1852. Henry Lunt stated, "It was supposed to have been accidentally done." John D. Lee wrote: "It was a shocking occurrence. Whether the boy was shot designedly or not was a consideration that remained to be proved."¹¹ Young Owens was tried, or rather examined, before Lee and Squire Leyno and held to bail for his appearance at the next term of the District Court. Circumstantial evidence was strong against him.

On Thursday, January 7, the Whittakers could not find one of their cows that had been turned out the night before. They supposed that the cow had been killed by either the Indians or some Spaniards passing through on their way to California. The Spaniards left the following Wednesday, January 11, and three of the settlers decided to go with them. At any rate, the cow was never found.

A meeting was held at the home of Brother Chatterley on Monday, February 2. After an address by Presiding Elder Carruthers, he proposed that Henry Lunt be his First Counselor and John Easton his Second Counselor. He felt that this decision was dictated to him by the Spirit of God, and they were unanimously supported. Lunt was also put in as Clerk and was chosen as a member of the committee, composed of three men, to manage the Public Works. Another committee was assigned to visit all the families in the settlement to make sure they were attending to their duties.¹²

It snowed and rained most of the day on February 4, 1852. That evening Lunt wrote a letter to George A. Smith informing him of the progress of the new settlement. He wrote:

I started from Parowan on Monday, November 11, 1851, with eleven wagons for this place. As we were traveling along breaking a new road nearly the whole

of the way, many serious reflections came to my mind. For instance, twelve months have scarcely elapsed since I had the first interview with you and came on the mission to Parowan. Then I knew but little what it was to help build up our Heavenly Father's Kingdom in making new settlements, and now I am leading a company myself to a large and delightful valley to form another new settlement. We have built a good corral and enclosed the fort. We have a bastion on each side of the fort and have one pair of double gates on the north side. We have all our cattle herded and corralled every night. Brother Carruthers has the faith and confidence of the Saints and peace is in our midst. We have not yet built the most important building, a meeting house, but are going to commence next week.

At the same time Lunt wrote the above letter, Matthew Carruthers wrote a letter to Governor Brigham Young which was confirmed by Lunt. Both of these letters were sent with Joseph Chatterley who was leaving for Salt Lake City the next day. Carruthers wrote:

Much respected and worthy brother: In as much as I have been appointed to preside in this place, I have considered it my duty to avail myself of the present opportunity now offered to send you a letter relative to our position and prospects in the Coal Creek settlement, knowing as I do the strong anxiety of your mind to get iron manufactured from the materials, so profusely scattered over the surface of the earth in this locality, for the use of the Territory and the upbuilding of the Kingdom of God. I have presumed to write you relative to our condition and prospects in this place connected with the above affair. Shortly after a number of the brethren had arrived at this place and built a corral, Brothers Bladen and Walker arrived and

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stated that they had been sent especially by the President to go forthwith and test the qualities of the iron ore and send back a sample with all possible haste. They, therefore, required a certain number of the brethren to come forward and assist in this work. But, for the following reasons, I advised the brethren to turn in with us and assist to close the fort--First, Brother Bladen brought no written instructions with him, and I found that his commencing forthwith was breaking in upon the policy and counsel of Brother George A. Smith and the general policy of your letter, and I thought it was better to abide by the counsel we had received until we had orders by the same authority to act otherwise. Second, the brethren had their families exposed to the severity of the winter and were unwilling to turn their attention to coal and iron digging until they had got cabins to live in. Third, we had been strictly charged to enclose the fort in order to secure ourselves against the Indians, as we are the most advanced southern settlement; consequently, we could ill spare from that important labor any of our hands. Fourth, and most important reason of all was that we could not, had we been willing, for the canyon was locked up with snow, and we could not possibly get coal to try the equipment.¹³

Cedar City was chartered as an official settlement or town on February 10, 1852.¹⁴ The congregation met at 10:00 a.m. on the banks of Coal Creek on Sunday, February 15; and, after they had sung a hymn and had prayer, Henry Lunt went into the water and rebaptized 33 persons. In the afternoon these people were ordained by Matthew Carruthers, J. L. Smith, and Bishop Lewis from Parowan. They met by Lunt's house for this procedure. At the same meeting, eleven men were ordained elders and Smith appointed Henry Lunt as the Indian Agent.¹⁵ Lunt wrote in his journal: "Sister Ellen Whittaker took supper with me and Mother Wiley." Everyone attended an

evening meeting where the congregation was addressed by Carruthers and Lunt, after which there was a testimony meeting. Several children spoke and one little boy said he was willing to do as his parents told him, and he also would do whatever Brother Carruthers and Brother Lunt told him. James Whittaker wrote about the event: "Every bosom seemed to be full of the Spirit of God."

By the middle of February the grass was beginning to grow, and the settlers began collecting posts to enclose their gardens and make pens for the livestock. A spot for gardens had been surveyed on the north side of the Fort. On Monday, February 16, Lunt wrote:

Considerable rain fell, water lay on the ground in holes and tracks which reminded me of wet weather in old England. The Lord be praised for the beautiful distilling showers on this dry and thirsty land. The rain reminded me of being in a house covered with mud, as wet dropped on me of a very muddy color. I did not murmur as I knew much better Saints than me had suffered. Grant, oh Lord, that we may live long upon the earth that we may enjoy health, peace, and plenty in our habitation, and raise up a posterity to thy honor and glory that shall come to stand upon Mount Zion as Savior. Preserve us, oh Lord, from the power of darkness, and through all the changing scenes of life. Fit and prepare us for the coming of our Redeemer, Jesus Christ, Amen and amen.

Lunt delivered a lengthy discourse from the fourth chapter of Ephesians at the Sunday meeting, February 28, at Brother Chatterley's house. The theme was, "Let all bitterness and wrath and anger and clamor and evil speaking be put away from you, with all malice."

Whittaker wrote in his journal: "Saturday, March 6, 1852, there was a strong south wind. The Indians had been stealing oxen from Johnson's herd and the brethren from his place had pursued the Indians and shot two of them. In the evening Brother Lunt called the brethren together and instructed them to have all their guns in

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readiness and to treat the Indians in a proper manner." The Indian, Chief Walker, and his band had been camping near the Fort. He was very thin and looked as if he had suffered with hunger during the winter. Some of the brethren collected about fifty pounds of flour and gave it to the Indians on March 7, after which the band of Indians left for Parowan. Walker seemed peaceable with the settlers. James Whittaker traded a tin bucket to a squaw for two buckskins. After the Indians reached Parowan on Thursday, March 11, it was reported that they shot Brother Wood's gray stud horse and there were several other horses missing. The Paiute Chief, Kanarra, and Chief Walker had a fist fight in John L. Smith's house. Walker declared that he would kill Kanarra and all his band for killing the Mormon's oxen and horses. That evening in a meeting Lunt again instructed the men to take care of their cattle and horses and, whenever they went out, go well armed.¹⁶ On Friday, March 12, a dozen well-armed men rode horses to Shirts' Creek to fetch Shirts and his family to the Fort until the Indian difficulties were over. That evening Henry Lunt and Ellen Whittaker went together to the wedding ceremony of Robert Henry and Mary Ross which was performed by President Carruthers.

A shot was heard in the Fort during the evening meeting on Sunday, March 14, and Henry went out to see what was happening. He found some brethren from Parowan and invited them to join the congregation. Bishop Lewis informed the group that they had received news from the passing travelers from Salt Lake City that the gentiles were burning the houses in Kanesville, Iowa, and the Saints had been warned to leave there by June next. There was likely to be war between England and America and there was, also, likely to be a great emigration to California. Most of the brethren in the congregation spoke on the subject.¹⁷

Henry blew the horn for muster on Monday, March 15, and the foot company was drilled by Lieutenant Colonel James A. Little. The horse company was drilled by Adjutant J. L. Smith. After parade they met in a quorum capacity concerning some difficulties existing among the brethren relative to the iron business. Brother J. L. Smith and others from Parowan instructed them to obey counsel and be led by those in authority. He said: "Some of you have got the big head and

think you know more than those that are placed above you which is wrong, and you must humble yourselves and be united."¹⁸

Some of the settlers were beginning to plant turnips, beets, onions, radishes, and lettuce in their gardens. Their domestic affairs seemed to be constantly interrupted by trouble with the Indians. Brother Shirts came from Parowan on Tuesday, March 16, and reported that the Indians had shot five arrows into an ox belonging to Bishop Robinson, but the Paiutes claimed there were only four Indians who were mad and would kill cattle, and all the rest of the Paiutes were friendly. On Saturday, March 20, some of the settlers, including Henry Lunt, followed the trail of one of James Whittaker's oxen which had been missing for several days. After about five miles, they found the bones very clean picked. They also found a very bloody arrow a short distance from where the ox had been butchered; however, they did not see any Indians. That evening they agreed to herd the cattle in turns.¹⁹

When Ellen Whittaker came to Cedar City with her father in November, Henry was immediately drawn to her. She was fair-complexioned, small and a very pretty girl. In a very short time she and Henry became very fond of each other. This association, undoubtedly, helped Henry forget about the girl he had left behind in England, and it was just a matter of time before he and Ellen decided on marriage. Actually, they must have been considering it for quite a while because Ellen had been sewing and preparing for the wedding. She was an expert milliner and seamstress and had made and sold many types of hats while in England. She had brought a supply of thread, lace, and silk from her homeland, which she used to continue her trade.²⁰ James Whittaker, Brother Wiley and Henry laid a floor and fixed up one of the rooms in Brother Bosnell's house on Wednesday, March 24, in preparation for the wedding celebration and feast. On Thursday, March 25, Henry Lunt and Ellen Whittaker were married. Ellen's father, James Whittaker, wrote the following detailed account in his journal of the proceedings that day:

My daughter, Ellen, was married to Brother Lunt today. Myself, James and Mary, with several others,

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attended the wedding. At twenty minutes to seven we left Cedar City for Parowan in two carriages--one drawn by four horses, the other by two. As we started, a salute was fired with guns which echoed through the mountains, and the city had the appearance of a joyful morn by the inhabitants being collected together to see us set off and giving us three cheers as we started. Soon after we left we saw it storming north and northwest; it came within a very short distance of us and continued to storm all around us nearly all the way to Parowan. About one mile before we got there the tire of one of the wheels of Brother Wood's carriage came off. It detained us about twenty minutes. We arrived at Parowan at twenty minutes past nine o'clock--a distance of twenty miles. We were met at the carriages by President John L. Smith and invited into his house.

Henry and Ellen were married at 1/4 to twelve in the morning by Bishop Lewis. Before the ceremony we sang the 40th Hymn, and after it we sang *Redeemer of Israel*. After the marriage they were blessed by the brethren with the richest of heaven's blessings. We breakfasted [actually, it was lunch] with the John D. Lees and left Parowan accompanied by another carriage containing President John L. Smith, Bishop Lewis, John D. Lee, and four ladies. Arrived at Cedar City at 4 o'clock when our ears were deafened with the cheering of the Saints and firing of guns. When we arrived at the assembly rooms there was a sumptuous feast prepared for about 150 persons.

After dinner a number of the brethren were amusing themselves in the center of the Fort by running races, jumping, etc. Shortly after, dancing commenced and was continued until four o'clock in the morning; a great variety of songs were sung and

several comic pieces performed. Joy and gladness seemed to be in every countenance. I never saw a party that enjoyed themselves like unto this--such order and a oneness of Spirit prevailed throughout the whole evening's entertainment. The horses on the carriages had roseates in their bridles and white ribbons attached there to some twelve inches long, which added to the appearance of the fine prancing animals.

The next day, Friday, March 26, Henry Lunt wrote:

Delightful morning. Myself and wife took breakfast with our Parowan friends at Brother Bosnell's house--had an excellent breakfast. After breakfast we commenced dancing again and continued until 5 o'clock in the evening. The Parowan friends returned home about one o'clock. We spent the afternoon with Father and Mother Whittaker in counsel together. In the evening I took Brother Wiley out for a walk and told him that I believed it was the will of the Lord that him and I should part, which he consented to do so.²¹

Henry and Ellen lived in a wagon box and had very few possessions. In addition to the bed, there was only one chair. They had very few dishes, and most of them were made of tin.²² Brother Whittaker helped Henry move the wagon on Saturday, April 3. They placed it at the north end of the house which the Whittakers were building, and they placed the two Whittaker wagons alongside. Henry, together with James and James Jr., was soon busy plowing, harrowing, and preparing the soil for a garden and crops. They planted wheat in what they called the big field which was a ten-acre plot.²³ On that same day, Lunt wrote: "In the afternoon I and my wife planted some peas and some lettuce seed in the garden." The day before, April 2, he wrote: "My cow, 'Ten,' calved this morning, and

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my other cow, 'Snip,' took the bull."

The weather was warming up and all the settlers were busy and happy in their new home. Peace and prosperity were in their midst. Henry wrote the following on Tuesday, April 6, 1852:

Twenty-two years today since the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints was first organized with six members. It now numbers not less than sixty thousand, and has been preached in the four quarters of the earth. I thank my Heavenly Father that I have the honor of being a member, and manifested my faith by my works by leaving my country and all, and gathering to these valleys of the mountains. I pray that I may be faithful unto the end as a faithful soldier of the Lord.²⁴

1. York F. And Evelyn K. Jones, *Mayors of Cedar City*, (Salt Lake City, Utah: Woodruff Printing Company, 1986) p. 5.
2. *Ibid.*, p. 5.
3. Daughters of the Utah Pioneers, *Our Pioneer Heritage*, Cedar City Public Library, p. 190.
4. James Whittaker, Sr., "James Whittaker Journal," 1851 Entry, p. 3.
5. Daughters of the Utah Pioneers, *op. cit.*, p. 190.
6. Henrietta Jones Lunt, "Father's Life," (1920), p. 26.
7. Daughters of the Utah Pioneers, *op. cit.*, p. 215.
8. James Whittaker, Sr., *op. cit.*, p. 3.
9. *Ibid.*, p. 4.
10. *Ibid.*, p. 5.
11. *Ibid.*, p. 9.
12. Henry Lunt, "Henry Lunt Journal," (Provo, Utah: B.Y.U. Library, copied in 1955 from original manuscript), p. 51.
13. Andrew Jensen, *L.D.S. Journal History*, Entry for February 1852.
14. Evelyn K. and York F. Jones, *op. cit.*, p. xi.
15. Henry Lunt, *op. cit.*, p. 52.
16. James Whittaker, Sr., *op. cit.*, p. 15.
17. *Ibid.*, p. 16.

18. *Ibid.*, p. 16.
19. *Ibid.*, p. 18.
20. Henrietta Lunt Jones, *op. cit.*, p. 45.
21. Henry Lunt, *op. cit.*, p. 53.
22. Henrietta Lunt Jones, *op. cit.*, p. 44.
23. James Whittaker, Sr., *op. cit.*, p. 23.
24. Henry Lunt, *op. cit.*, p. 5.